MODULE 4 WORKSHEET

Break the Stalemate Principled Negotiation Planner

Use this worksheet before and after a negotiation, especially one that has stalled. It takes 20–25 minutes. Fill in the parts that help; skip the rest.

Negotiation I'm preparing for: _____ **Date:** _____

01 Positions vs interests map

Write each side's position (what they ask for), then the interests behind it (why they ask for it). Ask yourself "why?" and "why not?".

ME / MY SIDE	THEM / THEIR SIDE
Position	Position
Interests (list several)	Interests (my best guess, to test)

Interests we share:

"How" / "What" questions to test theirs:

02 Six needs check

Tick the needs most at stake for each side. The strongest interests are usually here.

NEED	ME	THEM	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THIS DEAL
Security safety, reliability, risk	☐	☐	
Economic well-being money, resources, terms	☐	☐	
Belonging acceptance, partnership	☐	☐	
Recognition respect, status, visibility	☐	☐	
Control / autonomy influence, choice	☐	☐	
Fairness just process and outcome	☐	☐	

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03 People and perception prep

Separate the people from the problem before you walk in.

STEP	MY NOTES
1 · Consider perception How do they see this? What am I assuming about their intentions out of fear? Am I blaming them for my problem?	
2 · Acknowledge emotion What are they likely to feel? What do I feel? How will I let them let off steam, without reacting?	
3 · Soft communication Two "I" statements I will use instead of "you" statements. What is the purpose of what I say?	

04 Options brainstorm: invent, then judge

Invent first: write at least eight options without judging any of them. **Then judge:** tick the ones that meet my interests, theirs, or both. Options that tick both are your mutual gains.

#	OPTION (NO JUDGING YET)	MEETS MINE	MEETS THEIRS
1		☐	☐
2		☐	☐
3		☐	☐
4		☐	☐
5		☐	☐
6		☐	☐
7		☐	☐
8		☐	☐

Stuck? Ask "What if…?" · wear another hat (customer, competitor, innovator) · change the *timing*, the *scope* or the *terms*, not just the price · brainstorm alone first, then combine.

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05 Objective criteria and pressure plan

Decide which standards and procedures you will propose, and how you will respond to pressure.

FAIR STANDARD	SOURCE / EVIDENCE I WILL BRING
☐ Market rates	
☐ Industry standards	
☐ Legal precedents / regulations	
☐ Expert opinion	
☐ Historical data / past agreements	

A fair procedure I could propose (clear, consistent, transparent, impartial, participative; e.g. "one cuts, the other chooses", an independent valuer)

My principles for this negotiation (e.g. fairness, equality, legality)

PRESSURE I MIGHT FACE	MY RESPONSE (REDIRECT TO PRINCIPLE)
	"Let's stick to the agreed criteria." · "What standard would you suggest?"

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06 After-action review

Fill this in within 24 hours of the negotiation.

QUESTION	WHAT HAPPENED
Did I separate the people from the problem? Where did it become personal?	
Which of their interests did I uncover that I hadn't guessed?	
How many options did we put on the table before judging? Which one created mutual gain?	
Which objective criteria or fair procedures did we use? Did they accept them?	
Did I yield to pressure anywhere? What would I say next time?	
Soft, hard or principled: which approach did I mostly use?	

Agreed next steps (what, who, by when):

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